

telemetry

Telemetry — Opt-In Anonymous Scoring

TL;DR

Preston-Check telemetry is **off by default**. When you opt in, exactly one HTTP POST per scan is sent. The payload contains aggregate counts and a salted hash of your repo URL. **No source code, file paths, file names, or specific check names are ever transmitted.**

What gets sent

```
{
  "version": "1.7.1",
  "tier": "free",
  "lang": "typescript",
  "repo_hash": "sha256(remote.origin.url)",
  "pass": 120,
  "fail": 7,
  "warn": 14,
  "skip": 5,
  "total": 146,
  "timestamp": "2026-05-03T19:42:27Z"
}
```

That is the entire payload. It maps to `workers/telemetry/src/index.ts` on the server, which validates the schema and stores aggregates in Cloudflare KV (90-day TTL on raw records).

What is never sent

- Any source code content.
- File paths or file names.

- Specific check IDs that failed.
- Customer names, emails, or PII of any kind.
- Network addresses (the server sees your IP at the TCP layer; we strip it before storage).

The privacy promise is enforceable by reading `lib/telemetry.sh` — the function is fewer than 30 lines on purpose.

Why we ask

The data moat is the only Preston-Check asset competitors literally cannot copy. It powers the annual State of Fintech Security report, the peer-comparison feature in the dashboard, and the LLM training data that gets the false-positive filter sharper over time. Telemetry-emitting customers are the foundation of all of that — once a few hundred scans flow through, the dataset starts producing benchmarks no one else has.

How to opt in

There are three equivalent ways. Pick whichever fits your workflow.

Per-run flag

```
preston-check --telemetry-opt-in
```

Environment variable (good for CI)

```
export PRESTON_TELEMETRY=1  
preston-check
```

Config file

```
# config.yml  
telemetry: opt_in
```

Make it the default for your shell

```
echo 'export PRESTON_TELEMETRY=1' >> ~/.zshrc # or ~/.bashrc
```

After that, every Preston-Check scan from your machine reports an anonymous score. You can disable it for a specific scan with `--airgap`, which forbids all network calls and forces telemetry off regardless of config or env.

How to verify what gets sent

```
# Dry-run with verbose curl tracing – shows the exact payload, then aborts.
PRESTON_TELEMETRY=1 \
  PRESTON_TELEMETRY_ENDPOINT="https://httpbin.org/post" \
  preston-check --light
```

The endpoint override redirects the POST to a public echo service so you can confirm the payload visually before pointing at the real endpoint.

Custom endpoint (Enterprise)

Enterprise customers can self-host the telemetry collector. The full schema and a deploy-ready Cloudflare Worker live in `workers/telemetry/`. Point the runner at your own collector with:

```
export PRESTON_TELEMETRY_ENDPOINT="https://telemetry.acme.internal/v1/ingest"
```

This is also the path for air-gapped fintechs that want internal benchmarking without sending data to preston-check.com.

Opting back out

Either remove the flag/env var/config, or set `--airgap`. There is no delete request endpoint because the server stores no PII to delete — the only identifier is the salted repo-URL hash, which the server cannot reverse without the original URL string.